

Challenge Map — HMW statement bank

CENTRAL CHALLENGE

How might we make public transit better?

Down 1 — What does “better transit” mean?

- How might we make public transit more reliable?
- How might we make public transit more affordable?
- How might we make public transit more accessible?
- How might we make public transit safer?
- How might we make public transit more comfortable?
- How might we make public transit easier to understand?
- How might we make public transit more convenient?
- How might we make public transit faster?
- How might we make public transit more environmentally sustainable?
- How might we make public transit more responsive to community needs?
- How might we make public transit more welcoming to new riders?
- How might we make public transit more useful for people who do not own cars?

Down 2 — What causes those problems?

Reliability

- How might we reduce delays?
- How might we make schedules more predictable?
- How might we improve connections between routes?
- How might we reduce missed transfers?
- How might we provide better information when disruptions occur?

Affordability

- How might we reduce the cost of using public transit?
- How might we make fares more equitable?
- How might we make transit financially accessible to low-income riders?
- How might we reduce the financial barriers to becoming a regular transit rider?

Accessibility

- How might we make transit easier to use for people with disabilities?
- How might we make transit information more accessible?
- How might we accommodate different mobility needs?
- How might we make stops and stations easier to navigate?
- How might we make transit more accessible to people with sensory differences?

Safety

- How might we make riders feel safer waiting for transit?
- How might we make riders feel safer while riding transit?
- How might we improve responses to harassment?
- How might we improve lighting and visibility around transit stops?
- How might we make transit safer without making it feel hostile?

Convenience

- How might we reduce the amount of time people spend waiting?
- How might we make routes easier to understand?
- How might we make payment easier?
- How might we make transfers easier?
- How might we make transit fit more naturally into people's daily routines?

Down 3 - Specific design opportunities

- How might we provide riders with more accurate real-time information?
- How might we help riders recover from unexpected delays?
- How might we design better transfer points?
- How might we make bus stops more comfortable while people wait?
- How might we make transit information understandable without prior knowledge?
- How might we help people determine the best route for their needs?
- How might we make transit usable for people carrying groceries, luggage, or mobility equipment?
- How might we make transit easier to use at night?
- How might we improve communication between transit agencies and riders?
- How might we allow riders to communicate problems with routes or stops?
- How might we encourage people who currently drive to try transit?
- How might we make transit more appealing for occasional riders?
- How might we design transit around people's actual travel patterns?
- How might we reduce uncertainty throughout the transit journey?

Upward challenges

How might we improve people's ability to move around their communities?

- How might we make mobility accessible to everyone?
- How might we reduce people's dependence on private vehicles?
- How might we make transportation more equitable?
- How might we make it easier for people to participate in their communities?
- How might we make transportation work for people with different abilities?
- How might we connect people with employment, education, healthcare, and recreation?
- How might we reduce transportation-related inequality?

How might we make communities more connected?

- How might we make it easier for people to access community resources?
- How might we reduce isolation caused by transportation barriers?
- How might we connect neighbourhoods more effectively?
- How might we make cities easier to navigate without a car?
- How might we ensure transportation reflects the needs of diverse communities?

How might we create more sustainable communities?

- How might we reduce transportation emissions?
- How might we reduce the number of private vehicles on the road?
- How might we make sustainable transportation the easiest choice?
- How might we design communities where people do not need cars for everyday activities?
- How might we balance transportation efficiency with environmental sustainability?

Sideways challenges

Information

- How might we make transit information easier to find?
- How might we make transit information easier to understand?

- How might we make information trustworthy?
- How might we personalize transit information without compromising privacy?
- How might we communicate disruptions effectively?

Infrastructure

- How might we improve bus stops?
- How might we make transit stops comfortable in bad weather?
- How might we improve accessibility at transit stops?
- How might we make transit infrastructure safer?
- How might we design infrastructure around how people actually wait and move?

Riders

- How might we better understand why people choose not to use transit?
- How might we design for occasional riders?
- How might we design for people who depend on transit every day?
- How might we involve riders in transit decisions?
- How might we give marginalized communities greater influence over transit design?

Transit workers

- How might we improve conditions for transit operators?
- How might we reduce stress for transit workers?
- How might we improve communication between operators and riders?
- How might we give transit workers better tools to respond to problems?

System

- How might we make transit agencies more responsive?
- How might we improve coordination between transit services?
- How might we allocate transit resources more effectively?
- How might we make transit planning more evidence-based?
- How might we involve communities in deciding where transit should go?

Sources

Here is a brief plaintext APA list of sources that support your public transit challenge map, spanning the full paper set including lower-ranked papers near the end.

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